

Day 38 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Anti-Corruption, Lokpal/Lokayukta, RTI, Consumer Protection, and Human Rights

READING MATERIAL

Covers 4 distinct anti-corruption/rights mechanisms bundled in one syllabus clause: Lokpal/Lokayukta (anti-corruption ombudsmen), the RTI Act (transparency), the Protection of Human Rights Act/NHRC, and Consumer Protection law. Real exam evidence flags a sharp trap distinguishing the historical Magna Carta from India's own 1993 Human Rights Act.

Q: What is the Lokpal, what is the Lokayukta, and who can the Lokpal investigate?

A: Under the Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013: the Lokpal is a NATIONAL-level anti-corruption ombudsman body; the Lokayukta is its STATE-level counterpart. The Lokpal can inquire into corruption allegations against the Prime Minister (with specific safeguards/exclusions, e.g. matters of international relations, security, public order, atomic energy, and space are excluded from its PM-related jurisdiction), Union Ministers, Members of Parliament, and Group A central government officials.

Q: What does the RTI Act, 2005 allow citizens to do, and what are its key response-time rules?

A: It allows any Indian citizen to request information from a 'public authority' (a government body or instrumentality of the State). The public authority must reply within 30 days normally, or within 48 HOURS if the matter concerns a person's life or liberty.

Q: What is the Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993, and what body did it establish?

A: It established the National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) — constituted 12 October 1993 — along with State Human Rights Commissions and Human Rights Courts. It defines 'human rights' as rights relating to life, liberty, equality, and dignity of the individual, guaranteed by the Constitution or embodied in international covenants and enforceable by Indian courts.

Q: Real exam: The famous clause "No man shall be taken or imprisoned... or in any way destroyed, save... by the law of the land" comes from which document — and what's the trap?

A: The Magna Carta (1215, England) — NOT India's Protection of Human Rights Act 1993, and not the Bill of Rights or the UDHR either (those were offered as distractors in a real exam question). The trap: a reader who associates ANY 'rights/law of the land' phrasing with India's own modern Human Rights Act would answer wrong — this specific historical clause is from the much older English Magna Carta, the foundational ancestor of 'rule of law' and 'due process' traditions worldwide.

Q: Real exam: Which year was the Monopolies and Restrictive Trade Practices (MRTP) Act enacted, and what did it address?

A: 1969 — confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question (paired with other consumer/competition-related Acts and years). It addressed monopolistic and restrictive trade practices harming consumers, predating today's dedicated Consumer Protection framework.

Q: What is India's current Consumer Protection law, and what changed from the earlier framework?

A: The Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (effective 2020) replaced the earlier Consumer Protection Act, 1986. It established the Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) and Consumer Disputes Redressal Commissions at the District, State, and National levels, and added provisions for e-commerce, misleading advertisements, and product liability that the older 1986 Act did not cover.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Lokpal (national-level) and Lokayukta (state-level) are bodies established to:

- A. Regulate elections
- B. Investigate corruption allegations against public functionaries ✓**
- C. Issue passports
- D. Adjudicate consumer disputes

Explanation: Investigate corruption allegations against public functionaries. [easy, web-research]

2. Under the RTI Act, 2005, a public authority must normally respond to an information request within:

- A. 7 days
- B. 15 days
- C. 30 days ✓**
- D. 60 days

Explanation: 30 days (48 hours if life/liberty is involved). [medium, web-research]

3. If an RTI request concerns a matter of a person's life or liberty, the response must be given within:

- A. 24 hours
- B. 48 hours ✓**
- C. 7 days
- D. 15 days

Explanation: 48 hours. [medium, web-research]

4. The National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) was constituted under which Act, and in which year?

- A. Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013
- B. Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993 ✓**
- C. Right to Information Act, 2005
- D. Consumer Protection Act, 2019

Explanation: Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993. [medium, web-research]

5. The famous clause "No man shall be... imprisoned... or destroyed, save by the law of the land" is from:

- A. The Bill of Rights
- B. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights
- C. The Magna Carta ✓**
- D. India's Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993

Explanation: The Magna Carta (1215). [hard, question-bank-2025]

6. The Monopolies and Restrictive Trade Practices (MRTP) Act, addressing practices harmful to consumers, was enacted in:

- A. 1969 ✓**
- B. 1974
- C. 1986
- D. 1988

Explanation: 1969. [hard, question-bank-2025]

7. The Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (effective 2020) replaced which earlier Act?

- A. MRTP Act, 1969
- B. Consumer Protection Act, 1986 ✓**
- C. Sale of Goods Act, 1930
- D. Companies Act, 2013

Explanation: Consumer Protection Act, 1986. [medium, web-research]

8. Which authority did the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 newly establish, that the 1986 Act did not have?

- A. District Consumer Forum
- B. Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA) ✓**
- C. Finance Commission
- D. Election Commission

Explanation: Central Consumer Protection Authority (CCPA). [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Simple Interest

READING MATERIAL

Simple Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC favors word-problem variants (doubling time, comparing two loans, fractional rates with month-based time) over the bare 'calculate SI' formula alone.

Q: Formula: What is the Simple Interest formula, and how do you get the doubling time from it?

A: $SI = (\text{Principal} \times \text{Rate} \times \text{Time}) / 100$. A sum **DOUBLES** when SI equals the Principal itself: $P = (P \times R \times T) / 100 \rightarrow T = 100/R$ years. So at 8% per annum, doubling time = $100/8 = 12.5$ years = 150 months.

Q: Real exam (2024): In how many months will Rs.2,000 double itself at 8% per annum simple interest?

A: $T = 100/R = 100/8 = 12.5$ years = $12.5 \times 12 = 150$ months.

Q: Real exam (2022): What is the simple interest on Rs.1,000 for one year at 10% per annum?

A: $SI = (1000 \times 10 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}100$.

Q: Real exam (2024): Find the simple interest on Rs.68,000 at $16\frac{2}{3}\%$ per annum for 9 months.

A: Convert the mixed-fraction rate: $16\frac{2}{3}\% = 50/3\%$. Convert months to years: 9 months = $9/12 = 3/4$ year. $SI = 68,000 \times (50/3) \times (3/4) / 100 = 68,000 \times 12.5/100 = \text{Rs.}8,500$. (The 3s cancel neatly between the rate's denominator and the time's numerator — recognizing that shortcut avoids messy fraction arithmetic.)

Q: Real exam (2025): A borrows Rs.16,000 at 12% p.a. simple interest, B borrows Rs.12,000 at 18% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed (principal+interest) become equal?

A: Set up the equality: $16000 + 16000(0.12)t = 12000 + 12000(0.18)t \rightarrow 16000 + 1920t = 12000 + 2160t \rightarrow 4000 = 240t \rightarrow t = 16\frac{2}{3}$ years.

Q: Method — finding the rate when given principal, time, and final amount: A sum of Rs.5,000 becomes Rs.6,200 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate.

A: $SI = \text{Amount} - \text{Principal} = 6200 - 5000 = 1200$. Rearranged formula: $R = (SI \times 100) / (P \times T) = (1200 \times 100) / (5000 \times 3) = 120000/15000 = 8\%$ per annum.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. In how many years will a sum double itself at 5% per annum simple interest?

- A. 10 years
- B. 15 years
- C. 20 years ✓**
- D. 25 years

Explanation: $T = 100/R = 100/5 = 20$ years. [easy, authored]

2. Find the simple interest on Rs.2,500 for 1 year at 12% per annum.

- A. Rs.250
- B. Rs.275
- C. Rs.300 ✓**
- D. Rs.320

Explanation: $SI = (2500 \times 12 \times 1) / 100 = \text{Rs.}300$. [easy, authored]

3. Find the simple interest on Rs.54,000 at $13\frac{1}{3}\%$ per annum for 6 months.

- A. Rs.3,600 ✓**
- B. Rs.3,000
- C. Rs.3,300
- D. Rs.4,000

Explanation: $13\frac{1}{3}\% = 40/3\%$. 6 months = $1/2$ year. $SI = 54000 \times (40/3) \times (1/2) / 100 = 54000 \times 40/600 = 54000 \times (1/15) = 3,600$. [hard, authored]

4. C borrows Rs.20,000 at 10% p.a. simple interest, D borrows Rs.15,000 at 15% p.a. simple interest. In how many years will their total amounts owed become equal?

- A. 8 years
- B. 10 years

C. 20 years ✓

D. 25 years

Explanation: $20000 + 2000t = 15000 + 2250t \rightarrow 5000 = 250t \rightarrow t = 20$ years. [hard, authored]

5. A sum of Rs.8,000 becomes Rs.9,440 in 3 years at simple interest. Find the rate per annum.

A. 5%

B. 6% ✓

C. 6.5%

D. 7%

Explanation: $SI = 9440 - 8000 = 1440$. $R = (1440 \times 100) / (8000 \times 3) = 144000 / 24000 = 6\%$. [medium, authored]

6. What sum will yield Rs.900 as simple interest in 3 years at 6% per annum?

A. Rs.4,000

B. Rs.5,000 ✓

C. Rs.5,500

D. Rs.6,000

Explanation: $P = (SI \times 100) / (R \times T) = (900 \times 100) / (6 \times 3) = 90000 / 18 = \text{Rs.}5,000$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Seventeen Oranges" — Bill Naughton

READING MATERIAL

A humorous first-person story about a cart-driver for the Swift Delivery Company who is extremely fond of oranges, gets caught by a dock security officer ('Pongo') with 17 stolen oranges hidden in his apron — and, to avoid being caught with the evidence, eats all of them whole on the spot, peels/pips/chunks included, and pays the price with a week of stomach trouble.

Q: Who wrote "Seventeen Oranges", and what was the narrator's job?

A: Bill Naughton. The narrator was a cart driver for the Swift Delivery Company, driving a pony-and-cart in and out of the docks to deliver goods.

Q: What was the narrator especially fond of, and how did he usually hide them?

A: Oranges — he was very fond of eating them. He usually hid stolen oranges in his APRON.

Q: Who caught the narrator, how many oranges was he caught with, and why was the officer suspicious?

A: A dock security officer named Pongo caught him, with SEVENTEEN oranges found in his pockets/apron. Pongo was suspicious because too many people were stealing from the docks at the time.

Q: Real exam: Complete the sequence — "Children like to ____ crispy snacks. But the author... was very fond of ____ oranges. Eventually, he was forced to ____ all the ____ including ____."

A: "Children like to MUNCH crispy snacks. But the author... was very fond of EATING oranges. Eventually, he was forced to SWALLOW all the CHUNKS including PIPS" — confirmed by a real exam's fill-in-the-blanks question.

Q: Why was the narrator "forced" to swallow all the orange chunks and pips whole, and what happened to him afterward?

A: To destroy the evidence and avoid being caught red-handed with the stolen oranges by Pongo, he hurriedly ate/swallowed all 17 oranges whole — peels, pips, and all. As a result, he felt very sick for a week afterward, as the oranges 'worked away' in his stomach.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Seventeen Oranges" was written by:

- A. Ruskin Bond
- B. Bill Naughton ✓**
- C. James Thurber
- D. William Blake

Explanation: Bill Naughton. [easy, web-research]

2. What was the narrator of "Seventeen Oranges" especially fond of?

- A. Bananas
- B. Mangoes
- C. Apples
- D. Oranges ✓**

Explanation: Oranges. [easy, web-research]

3. How many oranges was the narrator caught with?

- A. 10
- B. 15
- C. 17 ✓**
- D. 13

Explanation: 17. [medium, web-research]

4. What job did the narrator do?

- A. Teacher
- B. Cart driver for the Swift Delivery Company ✓**
- C. Police assistant
- D. Cook

Explanation: Cart driver for the Swift Delivery Company. [medium, web-research]

5. Who was the security officer that caught the narrator with the stolen oranges?

- A. Clem Jones
- B. Officer Brown
- C. Pongo ✓**
- D. Peters

Explanation: Pongo. [medium, web-research]

6. What did the narrator usually wear to hide the stolen oranges?

- A. Jacket
- B. Sweater
- C. Apron ✓**
- D. Coat

Explanation: Apron. [medium, web-research]

7. Why did the narrator swallow all 17 oranges whole, peels and pips included?

- A. He was extremely hungry
- B. To destroy the evidence before being searched ✓**
- C. Pongo ordered him to
- D. He won a bet

Explanation: To destroy the evidence. [medium, web-research]

8. What happened to the narrator after swallowing all the oranges whole?

- A. Nothing, he felt fine
- B. He felt very sick for a week ✓**
- C. He was arrested anyway
- D. He got a promotion

Explanation: He felt very sick for a week. [medium, web-research]